

Brand & UI Guidelines — Analytics Prediction App

Sep 24, 2026 · @Yovun

Brand direction

The product should feel like a precise instrument, not a sci-fi dashboard: quiet neutrals, one confident brand color (Petrol), and forecasts shown with their uncertainty. People trust predictions that look measured and honest, not ones that look exciting.

We are	We are not
Precise: exact labels, units, timestamps	Flashy: gradients, glow, motion for its own sake
Calm: generous but purposeful whitespace, few colors	Futuristic: neon, glass, "AI magic" visuals
Candid: ranges, confidence, data freshness always visible	Overconfident: single exact numbers with no context
Plain-spoken: short, specific copy	Hype: "Unlock", "Supercharge", "AI-powered insights"

How to use this doc: sections on color, type and charts are the spec; the AI-slop analysis and Do's and Don'ts are the review checklist; the last section is the prompt to paste into your AI UI tool (v0, Lovable, Cursor, Claude, etc.). Replace [App Name] and the bracketed fields before using it.

Color system

Recommended brand color: **Petrol #16586F**, a deep blue-green on cool slate neutrals. Blue-green reads analytical and trustworthy (finance, science, instruments) while staying clearly apart from the indigo/violet that almost every AI-generated SaaS UI defaults to. Petrol is the only color that means "you can click this" or "this is the prediction".

Proportion rule: about 80% neutrals, 10–15% Petrol, under 5% semantic colors. If a screen looks colorful, something is wrong.

Neutrals (light mode)

Token	Hex	Use	Contrast on white
ink-900	#0E1726	Headings, key numbers, the "actual" data line	17:1
ink-700	#3B4556	Body text, table cells	9.7:1
ink-500	#6B7585	Secondary text, axis labels, captions	4.6:1 (min. for text)
ink-300	#B4BCC8	Disabled states, icons at rest; never body text	2:1
line	#DDE2E8	Borders, dividers, table rules	—
mist	#EEF1F4	Row hover, subtle fills, gridlines	—
canvas	#F6F7F9	App background	—
surface	#FFFFFF	Cards, panels, tables, modals	—

Brand and semantic

Token	Hex	Use
petrol-700 (primary)	#16586F	Primary buttons, links, active nav, selected state, forecast line (7.9:1 on white)
petrol-800	#10445A	Hover and pressed state of primary
petrol-500	#2B7F9C	Focus ring (2px), chart highlight
petrol-100	#E4EFF3	Selected table row, info banners, tag background
band	#16586F at 14% opacity	Forecast confidence interval fill
success	#1E7A4F / tint #E8F3ED	Better than expected, model healthy
danger	#B42318 / tint #FBECEA	Worse than expected, errors, drift alerts
warning	#A15C07 / tint #FBF1E3	Stale data, low confidence, needs review

Semantic colors always come with a sign, icon or word (+4.2%, "Below forecast"). Never rely on red vs green alone: about 1 in 12 men can't tell them apart.

Data palette (charts)

Use in this order; stop at 6 series and group the rest as "Other" in `ink-300`.

Order	Name	Hex
1	Petrol	<code>#16586F</code>
2	Ochre	<code>#D08C2B</code>
3	Slate blue	<code>#5C6FAE</code>
4	Terracotta	<code>#B4553D</code>
5	Sage	<code>#4F8A6B</code>
6	Plum	<code>#8A5A8C</code>

- **Actual vs forecast:** actuals in `ink-900` solid; forecast in Petrol dashed; interval in `band`.
- **Sequential (heatmaps, intensity):** `#E4EFF3` → `#A9CAD6` → `#6BA2B6` → `#2F7792` → `#10445A`.
- **Diverging (above/below forecast):** Terracotta `#B4553D` ← neutral `#F3F4F6` → Petrol `#16586F`. Orange-vs-blue stays readable for color-blind users; red-vs-green doesn't.

Dark mode

Token	Hex
<code>canvas</code>	<code>#0B111A</code>
<code>surface</code>	<code>#121A25</code>
<code>surface-raised</code>	<code>#18222F</code>
<code>line</code>	<code>#263244</code>
Text primary / secondary	<code>#E7EBF0</code> / <code>#9BA6B5</code>
Primary (Petrol, lifted)	<code>#5AAAC4</code>

Token	Hex
band	#5AAAC4 at 18% opacity

Dark mode is a quiet charcoal-navy, not black with neon. No glows, no colored shadows.

Typography, spacing and shape

Use **IBM Plex Sans** for all UI text and **IBM Plex Mono** for IDs, timestamps, model versions and code. Both are free on Google Fonts, built for technical products, and have clean tabular figures. They also avoid the Inter-plus-indigo look that marks a UI as machine-generated.

Type scale (base 14px, built for dense data screens)

Role	Size / line height	Weight
Page title	24 / 32px	600
Section title	18 / 26px	600
Card title, table header	14 / 20px	600
Body, table cells	14 / 20px	400
Caption, axis labels, helper text	12 / 16px	400
Key metric (hero number)	28 / 34px	500

- Weights 400, 500, 600 only. No 800–900 "black" headlines.
- Every number that sits in a column, KPI or axis uses `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums`, and numbers right-align in tables.
- Sentence case everywhere ("Forecast accuracy", not "FORECAST ACCURACY" or "Forecast Accuracy").

Spacing

- 4px base grid: 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48. No values in between.
- Card padding 16–20px; page gutter 24px on desktop, 16px on mobile; 24px between cards.

- Table rows 40px (default) or 32px (compact mode for power users).

Shape and elevation

Element	Radius	Border / shadow
Inputs, tags, small buttons	4px	1px line border
Buttons	6px	Solid fill or 1px border, no shadow
Cards, panels, modals	8px	1px line border, no shadow
Dropdowns, popovers, modals (floating only)	8px	0 4px 16px rgba(14, 23, 38, 0.08)

Nothing above 12px radius except avatars. Borders separate things; shadows are only for elements that float above the page.

Icons and motion

- One outline icon set at 1.5px stroke, 16px or 20px. Icons sit next to labels; icon-only buttons get a tooltip.
- No emoji anywhere in the product UI.
- Motion only confirms a state change: 120–200ms ease-out. No entrance animations on dashboards; respect `prefers-reduced-motion`.

Charts and prediction UI

Every prediction on screen must answer four questions: what is predicted, how sure the model is, as of when, and from which model. This is where an analytics prediction product earns or loses trust.

Anatomy of a prediction card

1. **Label** — what is predicted, with unit and horizon: "Revenue, next 30 days (USD)".
2. **Point estimate + range** — "1.24M" large, with "1.12M – 1.36M · 80% interval" beneath it.
3. **Change vs baseline** — "+6.1% vs last 30 days", with sign and arrow, not color alone.
4. **Confidence in words** — "High confidence" / "Low confidence: limited history", backed by a number on hover.

5. **Metadata line** in `ink-500`, Plex Mono — `model v2.3 · trained 22 Sep · data to 23 Sep 18:00`.

Forecast charts

- Actuals: solid `ink-900` line. Forecast: dashed Petrol line. Interval: `band` fill between upper and lower bounds.
- A thin vertical rule marks where the forecast starts, labeled "Today" or the cutoff date.
- Let users switch the interval between 80% and 95%, and always state which one is shown.
- Tooltip shows date, actual, forecast, interval and the gap between them.
- Offer a "How accurate has this been?" view: past forecasts vs what actually happened (backtest), with one accuracy figure (e.g. MAPE) explained in plain words.

Numbers

- Round to 2–3 significant figures: "1.24M", "94%", never "1,236,847.23" or "94.738%". False precision reads as false confidence.
- Always show units and the period. Abbreviate consistently (K, M, B).
- Probabilities: "72% likely" or "about 7 in 10"; avoid bare decimals like 0.7234.

Chart choice

Question the user asks	Use	Avoid
How does it change over time?	Line (with interval band for forecasts)	Area with gradient fill
Which items are biggest / rank highest?	Horizontal bar, sorted	Pie, donut, radar
What drives this prediction?	Horizontal bars of top 3–7 factors, signed	Word clouds, gauges
What is the exact value?	Table with right-aligned numbers	A chart the user must hover
Part of a whole (4 parts or fewer)	Stacked bar, or donut as last resort	3D pie, 8+ slices

- Horizontal gridlines only, in `mist` ; axis labels 12px `ink-500` .
- With 4 series or fewer, label lines at their end instead of using a distant legend.
- Say "associated with" for drivers, never "caused by", unless the model is causal.

States

- **Loading:** skeletons shaped like the real chart or table, not a spinner in the middle of a card.
- **Empty:** say why and what to do: "Needs 90 days of history — you have 41. Forecasts start on 12 Oct."
- **Stale data:** `warning` tint banner when data is older than the refresh schedule.
- **Error:** what failed, in plain words, and one next action (Retry, View logs, Contact admin).

What AI slop UI looks like

"AI slop" is the average of thousands of SaaS templates: it looks polished for three seconds, then says nothing specific about your product. For a prediction product the cost is higher than for most apps. It makes the tool look like a demo, and people don't make decisions with demos. These are the 25 patterns to recognise and reject.

Visual style

#	Pattern	What it looks like	Why it hurts
1	Indigo/violet gradients	Purple-to-blue or blue-to-pink gradients on headers, buttons, backgrounds; Tailwind <code>indigo-500</code> (<code>#6366F1</code>) as brand	The single most recognisable generated look; your brand disappears into it
2	Gradient text	Headlines or big KPI numbers filled with a gradient	Numbers look decorative, not measured; lower legibility
3	Glassmorphism and blobs	Frosted translucent cards over blurred color blobs, dot or grid backgrounds	Lowers contrast behind data; pure decoration

#	Pattern	What it looks like	Why it hurts
4	Neon dark mode	Black background, cyan/purple glows, colored shadows	Eye strain; charts compete with the glow
5	Over-rounding	16–24px radius on everything, pill buttons, pill tags	Toy-like; wastes space in dense tables
6	Shadows and hover-lift everywhere	Every card has a big shadow and scales up on hover, even when not clickable	False signals of what is interactive
7	Emoji and sparkles	 in headings; a sparkle icon on anything "AI"	Unserious; the sparkle says nothing about what the feature does
8	Colored left-border cards	A thick accent stripe down the left edge of cards and callouts	A signature generator habit; adds noise, not meaning
9	Default everything	Inter at default settings, 800-weight headings, tiny uppercase letter-spaced labels above every section	Anonymous; nothing ties the UI to your brand

Layout

#	Pattern	What it looks like	Why it hurts
10	Marketing layout inside the app	Big centered hero and headline on a dashboard	Pushes the actual data below the fold
11	Three-card feature grid	Three equal cards, each with an icon in a colored rounded square, title, two lines of text	Filler structure; no hierarchy
12	Badge overload	"New", "Beta", "AI", "Pro" pills scattered around	Everything shouts, so nothing stands out
13	Everything in identical cards	Every piece of content boxed the same way, same size	The eye can't find what matters most

Dashboards and data

#	Pattern	What it looks like	Why it hurts
14	The template dashboard	4 KPI cards (each with a green "+12.5%"), a line chart, a donut, a "Recent activity" table	Built for no one's actual question
15	Fake-looking data	Smooth upward curves, round numbers, every change positive	Users stop believing the real numbers too
16	Donuts, gauges, 3D	Pie/donut for everything, speedometer gauges, 3D charts, gradient area fills	Hard to compare values; decoration over reading
17	Rainbow and red/green	8+ saturated series colors; good/bad only as green/red	Unreadable, and fails for color-blind users
18	False precision, no uncertainty	"Predicted revenue: \$1,236,847.23", "Accuracy 98.7%" with no range, model, date	The fastest way to lose an analyst's trust

#	Pattern	What it looks like	Why it hurts
19	Decorative sparklines	Tiny trend lines with no scale, period or values	Looks informative, communicates nothing

Copy and interaction

#	Pattern	What it looks like	Why it hurts
20	Hype copy	"Unlock the power of your data", "AI-powered insights", "Seamlessly", "Supercharge", "Elevate"	Marketing voice inside a work tool reads as empty
21	Vague labels	Nav items "Insights", "Analytics", "Overview"; buttons "Get started", "Learn more" inside the app	Users can't predict what they'll find
22	Chatbot bubble as the AI feature	A floating chat icon in the corner	Hides the real value (the predictions) behind a text box
23	Motion everywhere	Every card fades up, numbers count up, backgrounds animate	Slows reading; distracting on every visit
24	Cartoon empty states	Friendly illustration + "Nothing here yet!"	No explanation, no next step
25	Inconsistent details	13px here, 15px there; random paddings; three button styles	Each component was generated separately and it shows

Do's and Don'ts

Use this as the review checklist for every screen, whether a designer, a developer or an AI tool made it.

Area	Do	Don't
Color	Neutrals for ~80% of the screen; Petrol only for actions, selection and forecasts	Gradients, violet/indigo, a second competing accent
Status color	Pair every semantic color with a sign, icon or word	Red vs green as the only signal
Typography	IBM Plex Sans, weights 400–600, tabular numbers, sentence case	Inter defaults, 800-weight headlines, gradient text, uppercase labels everywhere
Shape	4–8px radius, 1px borders, shadows only on floating elements	Pills, 16px+ radius, shadows and hover-lift on static cards
Layout	Left-aligned, one clear primary area per screen, dense but ordered	Centered hero layouts, three-card feature grids, identical boxes for everything
Dashboards	Design each screen around the 1–3 questions its users actually ask	The 4 KPI cards + line + donut + table template
Predictions	Point estimate + range + confidence + "as of" + model version	A single exact number with no context
Numbers	2–3 significant figures, with units and period	"\$1,236,847.23", "98.738%"
Chart types	Lines for time, sorted horizontal bars for ranking, tables for exact values	Pies, gauges, 3D, gradient area fills, rainbow palettes
Forecast charts	Solid actuals, dashed forecast, shaded interval, a "Today" marker	Forecast drawn exactly like history
Icons	One outline set, next to text labels	Emoji, sparkles, icons in colored circles
Copy	Specific and short: "Revenue forecast, next 30 days"	"Unlock AI-powered insights"

Area	Do	Don't
AI features	Explain the top drivers right where each prediction is shown	A chatbot bubble as the whole AI story
Motion	120–200ms transitions that confirm a change	Fade-ups, count-up numbers, animated backgrounds
Empty and error states	Say why, and give one next action	Cartoon illustration + "Nothing here yet!"
Dark mode	Charcoal-navy surfaces, lifted Petrol, no glow	Pure black with neon glows
Consistency	Tokens for every color, size and space; one button system	One-off values in each component

UI prompt (paste-ready)

Fill in the bracketed fields, attach your logo, and paste this into your AI UI tool. Ask for one screen at a time; generators drift on long multi-screen requests.

```
You are a senior product designer and front-end engineer building the UI for [App Name], an analytics and prediction application. [One sentence on what it predicts and for whom, e.g. "It forecasts weekly sales and stock-outs for retail operations managers."]  
  
Primary users: [roles], who use it daily to [main decisions]. They are analytical, busy, and skeptical of numbers they can't verify. The UI must feel like a precise instrument: calm, information-dense, and honest about uncertainty. It must NOT look like a generic AI-generated SaaS template.  
  
SCREENS  
[List the screens, e.g.:  
1. Overview: the 3 forecasts that need attention today  
2. Forecast detail: one metric with chart, range, drivers, accuracy history  
3. Models: model list with version, last trained, accuracy, status  
4. Settings]  
  
BRAND TOKENS (use exactly, as CSS variables / theme tokens; no other colors)  
Neutrals: ink-900 #0E1726 (headings, key numbers, actual line) | ink-700 #3B4556 (body) | ink-500 #6B7585 (secondary text, axis labels) | ink-300 #B4BCC8 (disabled only) | line #DDE2E8 (borders) | mist #EEF1F4 (hover,
```

gridlines) | canvas #F6F7F9 (app background) | surface #FFFFFF (cards)
 Primary (Petrol): #16586F | hover #10445A | focus ring #2B7F9C | tint #E4EFF3
 | forecast interval band = #16586F at 14% opacity
 Semantic: success #1E7A4F (tint #E8F3ED) | danger #B42318 (tint #FBECEA) |
 warning #A15C07 (tint #FBF1E3)
 Chart series, in order, max 6: #16586F, #D08C2B, #5C6FAE, #B4553D, #4F8A6B,
 #8A5A8C
 Dark mode: canvas #0B111A | surface #121A25 | raised #18222F | line #263244 |
 text #E7EBF0 / #9BA6B5 | primary #5AAAC4
 Proportion: ~80% neutrals, 10-15% Petrol, under 5% semantic colors.

TYPE AND SHAPE

- Fonts: IBM Plex Sans for UI, IBM Plex Mono for IDs, timestamps, model versions. Weights 400/500/600 only.
- Scale: page title 24/32, section 18/26, body and tables 14/20, captions 12/16, key metric 28/34.
- tabular-nums on all numbers; numbers right-aligned in tables; sentence case everywhere.
- 4px spacing grid (4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48). Card padding 16-20px.
- Radius: 4px inputs and tags, 6px buttons, 8px cards and modals. Nothing larger except avatars.
- Cards: 1px border, no shadow. Shadow only on floating elements (menus, popovers, modals): 0 4px 16px rgba(14,23,38,0.08).
- One outline icon set, 1.5px stroke, always paired with a text label.
- Motion: 120-200ms ease-out for state changes only; honor prefers-reduced-motion.

PREDICTION AND CHART RULES

- Every prediction shows: label with unit and horizon, point estimate, interval ("1.12M - 1.36M, 80% interval"), change vs baseline with sign, confidence in words, and a metadata line (model version, trained date, data as of).
- Round to 2-3 significant figures. Never show false precision.
- Forecast charts: actuals solid ink-900, forecast dashed Petrol, shaded interval band, vertical "Today" marker, 80%/95% interval toggle, tooltip with date, actual, forecast, interval and gap.
- Lines for time series, sorted horizontal bars for rankings and drivers, tables for exact values. Horizontal gridlines only, in mist.
- Drivers: top 3-7 factors as signed horizontal bars, worded "associated with", never "caused by".
- Include a backtest view: past forecasts vs actuals, with one plain-language accuracy figure.
- States: skeleton loaders shaped like the content; empty states that say why

and what to do next; a warning banner for stale data; errors with one next action.

DO NOT (hard rules; reject any output that breaks them)

- No gradients of any kind. No purple, violet or indigo. No default Tailwind indigo.
- No gradient text, glassmorphism, blurred blobs, glows, neon, or decorative grid/dot backgrounds.
- No emoji, no sparkle icons, no icons inside colored circles or squares.
- No colored left-border stripes on cards or callouts.
- No pill-shaped buttons, no radius above 8px on cards, no shadows or hover-scale on static cards.
- No centered marketing hero, no three-card feature grids, no badge clutter ("New", "AI", "Beta").
- No template dashboard of 4 KPI cards + line chart + donut + recent-activity table.
- No pie, donut, gauge, radar or 3D charts; no gradient area fills; no rainbow palettes; never red vs green as the only signal.
- No prediction without a range, a confidence level and an "as of" date.
- No hype copy: unlock, supercharge, seamless, elevate, "AI-powered insights", "Get started" inside the app.
- No floating chatbot bubble.
- No fade-up entrances, count-up numbers or animated backgrounds.
- No fake-looking sample data: use realistic, slightly noisy values, including some negative changes.

LOGO

Use the attached logo top-left in the navigation, at least 20px tall, with clear space equal to the logo mark's height. Do not recolor, stretch or add effects to it.

OUTPUT

[Your stack, e.g. React + TypeScript + Tailwind, tokens in the theme config and CSS variables for light and dark.] Build [first screen] first. Before you finish, audit the result against the DO NOT list and fix every violation.

If the tool drifts back toward gradients or rounded cards on later screens, paste the DO NOT block again and ask it to audit the current screen against it.

Fitting this to your logo

The neutrals, type and chart rules work with any logo; only the primary color may need to change. The logo wasn't shared with this doc, so pick the row that matches it (or share the file and the palette can be checked against it directly).

Your logo's main color	What to do with the UI primary
Blue, teal, navy or green	Use the logo color as primary if it gives at least 4.5:1 contrast with white text; otherwise keep Petrol. Keep everything else.
Red, orange or yellow	Keep Petrol for actions and data. The logo color stays in the logo only, so it never gets confused with danger or warning states.
Purple or violet	Keep Petrol. A purple UI will read as template-made; the logo alone carries the brand hue.
Black, grey or multicolor	Keep Petrol with the neutrals. The logo sits on white or on <code>ink-900</code> .

Logo usage

- Two versions: full color on light surfaces, all-white on `ink-900` and dark mode.
- Clear space on all sides equal to the height of the logo mark; minimum 20px tall in the app nav.
- Never recolor, stretch, rotate, outline, add shadow or glow, or place it on gradients or photos.